

# Yurii Rochniak

> Berlin, Germany

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Blog: <https://grem1.in>



## Bio

Senior Cloud Platform Engineer / SRE Lead with 10+ years of experience in building scalable and reliable user-friendly platforms and CI/CD solutions on top of AWS and Kubernetes using Terraform, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, and custom operators and automations in Go and Python.

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## Technologies

**Cloud:** AWS, Terraform, Atlantis

**Orchestrators & CI/CD:** Kubernetes, Helm, Jenkins (Groovy), GitHub / GitHub Actions, ArgoCD

**DBs, tools, and languages:** PostgreSQL, Debezium, Redis, Go, Python, Bash, TypeScript

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## Career Path

**March 2024 - present:** [Preply](#) (a global language learning platform) - Senior Cloud Platform Engineer

- Transformed the approach to **SLO** to represent actual user journeys to provide more accurate calculations for **SLA** for the business customers.
- Revamped the **RFC** process for decision-making in the company by updating the template and leading the "RFC of the Month" initiative internally.
- Reduced API layer resource consumption by **~80% CPU and 90% RAM** by driving the company-wide migration from Apollo Gateway to Apollo Router.
- Contributed to the **AI** adoption by introducing **skills** and **harnesses** to right-size Kubernetes workloads and generate reliable Helm manifests.
- Enabled the ML team to create Databricks workspaces on their own with just about 5 lines of code by providing a **Terraform** module.
- Improved the predictability of the configuration changes in **Kubernetes** by introducing **Helm Unittest** into the company.
- Active interviewer to get the best new talent to the company.

**July 2019 - March 2024:** [N26](#) (online bank) - Lead SRE

- Introduced **SLO** for **Kubernetes** components (add-ons).
- Automated compliance workflows by creating **Go CLI tools**, which reduced the execution time from 8 hours of manual work down to under 3 hours.

- Enabled product engineers to deploy services with less configuration by abstracting away service discovery and secrets management with custom **Kubernetes operators**.
- Decreased the lead time to create a fully functional **Kubernetes** cluster to ~30 minutes and a single command by creating a CLI cluster-management tool in **Go**.
- Reduced the footprint of internal tests for **Helm** charts to a couple of lines of code per test by creating an internal library to test charts with **Go** and **Terratest** and later **Helm Unittest**.
- Introduced a highly available setup for **Salt** master nodes as well as decreased MTTR to ~5 minutes using **AWS EFS**.

**January 2018 - June 2019: [Preply](#) (global language learning platform) - CloudOps Engineer**

- Decreased the deployment time of a monolithic application from 30 to 10 minutes by a migration from AWS Elastic Beanstalk to **Kubernetes**.
- Increased time to market for the new features from 1 deploy in a few days to a couple of deploys a day by implementing a CI/CD platform based on **Jenkins**.
- Eliminated staging environment congestion by implementing dynamic feature environments for product engineers in **Kubernetes**.
- Introduced **Terraform** to the company as a standard **IaC** solution.
- Decreased MTTR by adopting **DataDog** as an observability solution.
- Increased the team's throughput by adopting **Kanban** methodology.
- Pioneered the incident management process, including the culture of postmortems.

**September 2016 - January 2018: [Adobe Advertising Cloud \(ex-TubeMogul\)](#) (demand-side platform for online advertising) - Systems Engineer**

- Improved the automation of the existing infrastructure in **AWS** and **OpenStack** using **Terraform** and **Puppet**.
- Ensured the stability of internal systems by providing operational and oncall support using Nagios and **Sensu** with custom **Ruby** modules.

**October 2014 - September 2015: [VolPlatinum](#) (International VoIP provider) - Support Engineer**

**January 2014 - October 2014: [LuckyNet](#) (Internet service provider) - Support Engineer**

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**Education**

**2009 - 2015 - National Technical University of Ukraine "Kyiv Polytechnic Institute." [Institute of Telecommunication Systems](#)**

- Master's degree in telecommunication systems and networks
  - Bachelor's degree in telecommunications
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## Personal Projects

### Open-source contributor:

- [AWS VPC Peering Terraform Module](#) used in production by other people.
- [AWS Cost Exporter](#) - a tool to export AWS Cost Explorer data in Prometheus format.

### Community builder:

- Telegram channel and Substack newsletter about DevOps: <https://t.me/catops>
- Former organizer of the [DevOps Days Ukraine conference](#)

### Technical author and public speaker:

- [Load Testing Apollo Router](#) - on pre-production load tests.
- [A Route to Apollo](#) - about the migration to Apollo Router.
- [How do we use Terraform at Preply](#)
- [Public talks](#)